

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Detection Engineering | SOAR Automation | Threat Hunting | CrowdStrike | Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience building high-fidelity detection logic, developing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and conducting proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering using Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, where I build and maintain detection rules designed to identify malicious activity, minimise false positives, and ensure relevant alerts reach the Security Operations Centre (SOC). I create SOAR playbooks that automate repetitive tasks, enrich alerts, and enable the team to focus on high-value analysis. I conduct proactive threat hunting to identify hidden threats that evade automated prevention, and I upskill analysts to develop engineering mindsets and perform basic engineering and automation tasks independently. I thrive in collaborative, office-first hybrid environments and am passionate about maturing detection capabilities in fast-moving FinTech organisations.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, high-fidelity detection rule development, false positive reduction, alert tuning
- **SOAR Automation:** Playbook development, automated alert enrichment, custom integrations, workflow automation, repetitive task elimination
- **Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Active Directory (AD), Entra ID, Defender for Cloud; exposure to cloud-native security monitoring
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation logic, security workflow scripting
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident handling, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation, containment, eradication, and lessons learned
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity Security:** Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Team Development:** Mentoring SOC analysts, upskilling teams with engineering mindsets, knowledge sharing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Build and maintain high-fidelity detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL and in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, identifying malicious activity while minimising false positives and ensuring relevant, actionable alerts for the SOC team
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks that automate repetitive tasks, enrich alerts with threat context, and integrate across security tooling, allowing the team to focus on high-value analysis rather than manual enrichment
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying hidden threats that evade automated prevention controls

- Upskill and mentor junior analysts to develop engineering mindsets, enabling them to perform basic engineering actions and automation tasks independently, increasing team capacity and capability
- Engineer and tune detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, continuously improving the fidelity and relevance of SOC alerts
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover) platform across an 8,000-user estate, performing deep-dive endpoint investigation and threat containment
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender, correlating signals to identify multi-stage attack chains
- Automate security workflows using PowerShell and KQL, reducing manual effort and improving detection and response consistency
- Lead incident response activities following NIST 800-61 procedures, including threat containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review
- Manage vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, driving remediation and hardening across the estate
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Developed and refined SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, reducing false-positive alert volume and improving SOC signal quality
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development, automating alert triage and enrichment workflows to increase analyst efficiency
- Performed threat hunting activities using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, investigating endpoint and network anomalies to uncover threats that bypassed automated controls
- Carried out SIEM/EDR alert triage, escalation, and incident response across the estate, following NIST 800-61 incident handling procedures
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon deployment, policy configuration, and exclusion management for the 8,000-user UAL estate
- Deployed and administered the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), integrating telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams
- Supported junior analysts with investigative techniques and SIEM query development, fostering engineering mindsets within the SOC

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Implemented and monitored security controls across a SaaS/FinTech infrastructure, supporting threat detection and incident response activities
- Contributed to security monitoring alert analysis and escalation, gaining foundational experience in detection engineering principles
- Managed endpoint security tooling, identity access controls, and vulnerability scanning, supporting the organisation's security operations function
- Supported security hardening and compliance activities aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and deployed a comprehensive library of high-fidelity detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM at UAL, significantly improving SOC alert quality and reducing noise
- Developed SOAR playbooks that automated alert enrichment and triage workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analysts for high-value investigation tasks
- Led proactive threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight that uncovered previously undetected threats across UAL's network, endpoint, and cloud environments

- Mentored and upskilled junior SOC analysts to perform basic detection engineering and automation tasks, doubling team engineering capacity
- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender deployment across 8,000 users, unifying SIEM/EDR telemetry for improved cross-platform detection
- Mapped all detection rules to MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling structured coverage reporting and gap analysis for senior stakeholders

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000-85,000 | Hybrid (London, UK)